



Presented by The High End

# CARDBOARD PLAYHOUSE

## Full-Size Walk-In House with Door, Windows & Roof

Build a full-size cardboard house they can actually walk into. Move-in ready.

|             |                          |                   |                         |                 |
|-------------|--------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------|-----------------|
| AGES<br>3–8 | BOXES<br>4–6 Large Boxes | TIME<br>2–3 Hours | DIFF<br>Intermediate ** | PIECES<br>4 pcs |
|-------------|--------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------|-----------------|

**CARDBOARD NEEDED:**  
4–6 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each)

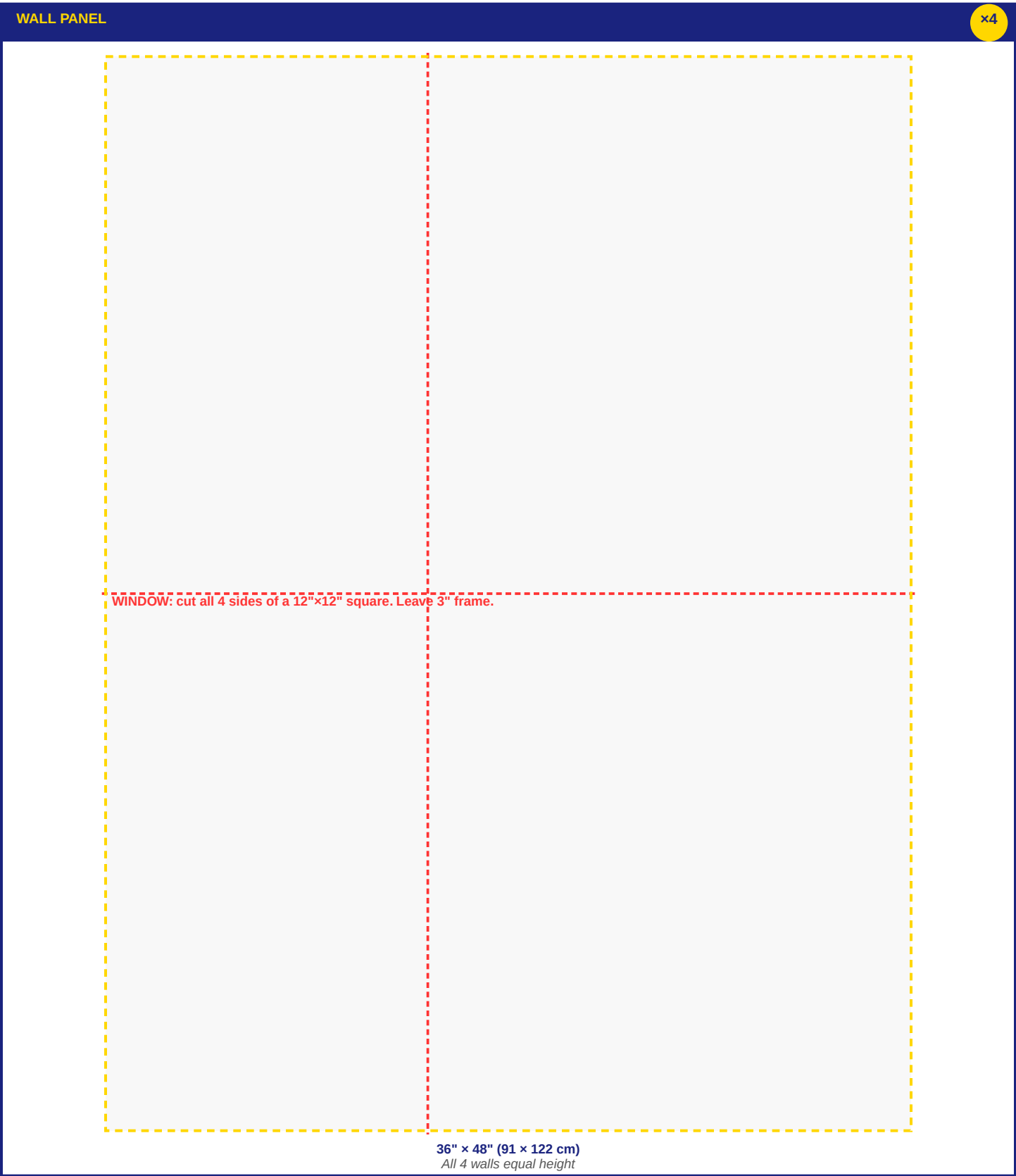
**MISSION GOAL:**  
Build a full-size walk-in playhouse: 4 walls, working door, 2 windows, peaked roof, chimney.



# WALL PANEL

36" × 48" (91 × 122 cm) | Cut ×4

CUT  
**x4**



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT — scissors or box cutter on this line

NOTE: All 4 walls equal height



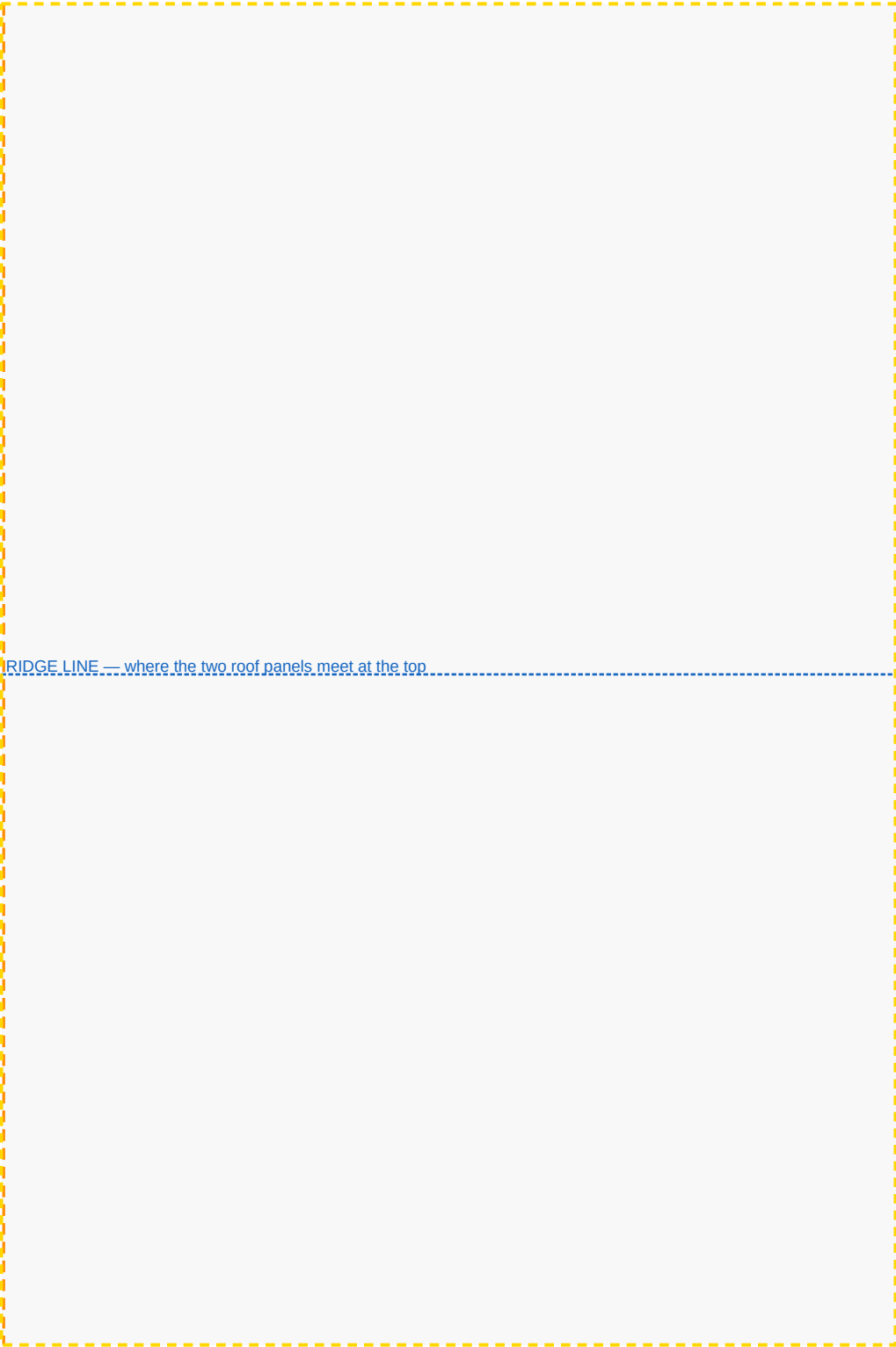
ROOF PANEL

24" x 36" (61 x 91 cm) | Cut x2

CUT  
x2

ROOF PANEL

x2



24" x 36" (61 x 91 cm)  
*Two panels meet at the ridge*

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

|                                              |                                                      |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line | SCORE — press hard with ruler but do NOT cut through |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|

NOTE: Two panels meet at the ridge



# GABLE TRIANGLE

24" x 18" (61 x 46 cm) | Cut x2

CUT  
x2

GABLE TRIANGLE

x2

CUT TRIANGLE SHAPE: bottom edge is straight, top two sides angle to a center peak

BASE EDGE — tape to top of front/rear wall

24" x 18" (61 x 46 cm)  
Fills gap between wall top and roof peak

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

|                                              |                                      |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line | TAPER — cut diagonally to this point |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|

NOTE: Fills gap between wall top and roof peak



CHIMNEY PANEL

8" x 12" (20 x 30 cm) | Cut x4

CUT  
x4

CHIMNEY PANEL

x4

8" x 12" (20 x 30 cm)  
4 panels form chimney box

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: 4 panels form chimney box

# WHAT YOU NEED — CARDBOARD PLAYHOUSE

## CARDBOARD PIECES — 4 TOTAL (4–6 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each))

×4

### Wall Panel

36" × 48"

*All 4 walls equal height*

×2

### Roof Panel

24" × 36"

*Two panels meet at the ridge*

×2

### Gable Triangle

24" × 18"

*Fills gap between wall top and roof peak*

×4

### Chimney Panel

8" × 12"

*4 panels form chimney box*

## TOOLS & SUPPLIES

+ 4–6 large cardboard boxes (appliance size)

+ Box cutter — ADULT USE ONLY

+ Packing tape (3+ rolls)

+ Paint or markers in child's favorite colors

+ Extra cardboard for door handle, window frames

+ Ruler + pencil

### FUN FACT!

*The smallest house ever lived in full-time was 8 feet wide. Your cardboard house might be bigger.*

### CHALLENGE!

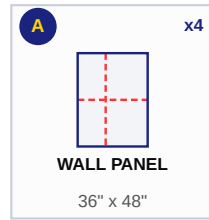
Housewarming party! Once built, set a table inside, invite stuffed animals, have a snack. What's the most people you can fit?

1

## STEP 1: FLATTEN & PLAN

Flatten all boxes. Lay all 4 Wall Panels on the floor. Mark which wall gets the door and which 2 get windows BEFORE cutting anything.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



2

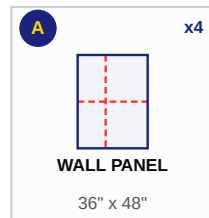
## STEP 2: BUILD 4 WALLS

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Stand the 4 Wall Panels upright and tape all 4 corners — 3+ layers inside AND outside. House must be square. Measure the two diagonals — they must be equal. Adjust corners before tape dries.

**SAFETY:** Two people needed to hold walls while taping each corner.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



3

## STEP 3: CUT THE DOOR

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

On the door wall: cut 3 sides of the door ( cut marks on template — left side, right side, bottom). Leave the TOP EDGE uncut as the hinge. Fold it open. Add a cardboard handle tab on one side.

**SAFETY:** Adult cuts only. Door bottom edge must be smooth — no tripping hazard.

4

## STEP 4: CUT THE WINDOWS

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

On 2 side walls: cut 4-sided window openings ( cut marks on template — 12" x 12" (30 x 30 cm) each). Leave 3" (8 cm) frame on all sides. Add cardboard cross-strips through each window.

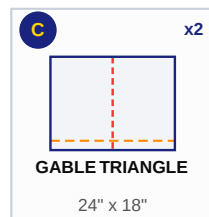
**SAFETY:** Adult cuts all window openings.

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## STEP 5: ADD GABLE ENDS

Cut both Gable Triangles (taper marks on template). These fill the triangular gap between the top of the front/rear walls and the roof peak. Tape to front and rear wall tops.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

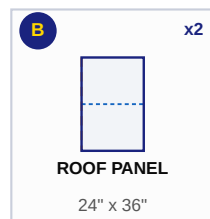


6

**STEP 6: ADD THE ROOF****! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED**

Lay both Roof Panels across the top — one on each side, meeting at the center ridge (score line on template marks the ridge). Tape the ridge seam from the inside. Tape roof panels to the tops of all 4 walls.

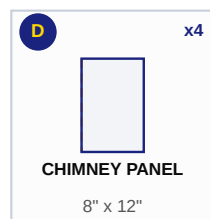
**SAFETY:** Two people needed — one holds roof panels, one tapes.

**PIECES USED IN THIS STEP**

7

**STEP 7: BUILD THE CHIMNEY**

Tape all 4 Chimney Panels into a rectangular tube (fold marks on template show attachment edges). Mount off-center on the roof. Tape through the roof into the chimney sides.

**PIECES USED IN THIS STEP**

8

**STEP 8: DECORATE**

Paint the child's favorite colors. Draw brick lines. Add flower boxes under windows. Paint a name on the door. Draw a welcome mat at the entrance.

9

**STEP 9: QUALITY CHECK**

Child walks through door without ducking. Windows visible. Roof fully covered. Chimney upright. House stands without being held. Compare to cover photo. That's the standard.

**QUALITY CHECK!**

Does your build match the cover photo? Compare side by side before you call it done.

"Build It. Own It." — Tatum & Kash Cardboard Creations